

Petri Mikael Autio

Product Leader | WASH & International Development Technology

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PROFILE

Product leader with 8+ years of product leadership experience, heading product for both mWater and Solstice. mWater is the world's most widely used free data platform for water, sanitation, and hygiene (WASH), while Solstice extends that work into health, education, agriculture, and other sectors. Directed design, prioritization, testing and rollout of 300+ major features serving 390,000+ users across 200 countries and territories. Background spans quantitative hedge fund work, international development with WaterAid and the Red Cross, data systems, and team management since 2016. Combines deep WASH sector knowledge and broader SDG and govtech work with hands-on technical skills to bridge user needs, business requirements, and engineering capacity.

EXPERIENCE

Venture Lead

Current

Stellar Data (stellardata.co) | mWater's for-profit subsidiary

Lead Stellar Data's implementation and advisory work, helping organisations put data systems into operational use.

Head of Product

Mar 2018 – Present

mWater (mwater.co) & **Solstice** (solstice.world) | Remote

Product strategy, roadmap ownership, and feature delivery for a free data platform and digital public good used by governments, utilities, UNICEF, and hundreds of NGOs to manage WASH data at national scale.

- Directed design and rollout of 300+ major features across mobile data collection, dashboards, GIS mapping, asset management, water system planning, AI capabilities, and workflows
- Launched and led Solstice, the sector-agnostic sibling platform extending mWater's technology to health, education, agriculture, and other SDG domains, and drove its early adoption (Medair, World Vision ESCA, WWF, and others)
- Authored and executing a multi-phase AI roadmap: shipped AI-powered translations (2024-2025), workflows engine, calculated data sources, and an AI-powered data integrator (2026, funded by UNICEF Madagascar)
- Coordinates and manages all mWater communications: portal news feed (hundreds of thousands of unique visitors/year), company blog, LinkedIn (grown from 500 to 5,000+ followers), and YouTube channel (250K+ views)
- Hired staff and managed distributed teams across the US, Canada, Haiti, Uganda, Ethiopia, Indonesia, and Nepal. Selected and mentored interns from the University of Chicago
- Drove internationalization to 25+ portal languages including Bangla, Burmese, Khmer, Tetun, and Tajik
- Runs partner training for CAWST, Medair, Netherlands Red Cross, UNICEF, USAID IUWASH, Water for People, DigDeep, Clear Cambodia, and others
- Conference presentations and panels at IWA World Water Congress, Stockholm World Water Week; also at UNC Water and Health, Colorado WASH Symposium, Brisbane WASH Futures, and AfWA

Systems Advisor - Planning, Monitoring, Evaluation & Reporting

Sep 2015 – Aug 2018

WaterAid | London

- Scoped, configured, and deployed a global management information system to 20 country programmes
- Developed system administration toolsets for data quality and good system use
- Built and maintained systems integrations across the organization
- Oversaw mobile data collection, analysis, and mapping tools. Team management from 2016

Programme Officer - Analytics & Insight

May 2014 – Sep 2015

WaterAid | London

- Data analysis and visualization of project implementation across WaterAid's portfolio
- Supported post-implementation sustainability monitoring processes
- Developed mobile data collection, mapping, and analysis tools

CRM Services Officer

Feb 2013 – May 2014

WaterAid | London

- Database administration and training workshops for a wide range of users
- Automated data imports with VBA and Python

GIS Developer (Volunteer)

Sep 2012 – Feb 2013

British Red Cross | London

- Mapping tools with D3.js, PHP, SQL. Python scripting

Operations Analyst

Mar 2011 – Jun 2012

GSA Capital | London

- Trade reconciliations, treasury automation (VBA), risk management

EDUCATION

MSc Development Studies (Merit) - University of Glasgow, 2009-2010

MA (Hons) History & Philosophy (First) - University of Glasgow, 2005-2009

TECHNICAL SKILLS

TypeScript, JavaScript, React, Node.js, Python, C#, PostgreSQL, SQL, REST API design, D3.js, Leaflet, MapboxGL, CSS, HTML5, Git, GIS, agentic AI development, local LLMs, prompt engineering, PowerBI, AWS, Docker, Linux, VBA, ETL, data visualization, unit testing.

KEY PROJECTS MANAGED AT MWATER

CRS Azure (azurewater.org), digital platform for small water utilities. USAID Haiti, platform for all urban utilities in-country. Ethiopia CO-WASH, one of Africa's largest WASH monitoring programs. Uganda RUMIS (rumis.ug), rural and urban water MIS. Malawi national water point database, 120K+ points. Papua New Guinea WASH MIS (umben.mwater.co). USAID IUWASH Tangguh, Indonesia. Water Mission systems integration. UNICEF-LIXIL youth citizen reporter monitoring. Medair Solstice implementation and indicator development. EquityTool integration.

CONSULTING & INDEPENDENT WORK

Netherlands Red Cross data preparedness program. Water for People Honduras data management. LM International Ethiopia training. Clear Cambodia WASH systems. Conference apps for Colorado WASH Symposium and UNC Water & Health. Personal projects include globally viral philosophy visualizations, a health research blog, and game prototypes (Unity, C#).